



DELHI POLICE

STANDING ORDER No. 454 /2018

'PRAHARI' SCHEME

1. INTRODUCTION

Prahari - a Force Multiplier for Policing – is an initiative of Delhi Police for eliciting active participation of various stakeholders like Private Security Guards and Chowkidars in prevention of crime. It aims at promoting a feeling of ownership and camaraderie in the community to foster better police-public relations. With more and more people turning to private security for personal safety, that of their families and property, as also that of their residential colonies and business establishments, it is in the interest of Delhi Police to sensitize and involve such private security personnel with a view to maximizing their performance in the overall interest of the safety and security of the community.

With the above purpose in mind, the need for institutionalized partnerships and cooperation between the public and private sector security in community policing, can hardly be over-emphasized. The level of cooperation can be enhanced through joint training, regular joint security briefing meetings and crime mapping, physical and information resource sharing as well as reduced suspicion between the two entities. This can significantly and qualitatively enhance the participation of the private security providers in community policing.

2. AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

The *Prahari* Scheme is a veritably potent community policing initiative inasmuch as it emphasizes on proactive enforcement that works on the proposition that street crime can be reduced to a great extent through greater community involvement and integration between citizens and police. In this initiative, all the stakeholders and officers aim to devote quality time to develop

a "partnership" to:- (a) Prevent and counter crime; (b) Maintain order; and (c) Reduce the fear of crime.

The *Praharis* Scheme runs on the basic principle that law can be better enforced and crime can be better prevented with the cooperation of the *Praharis* (Private Security Guards and Chowkidars). Under this Scheme, the Delhi Police identifies and involves various stakeholders like Guards and Chowkidars primarily for prevention of the various types of property crimes such as robberies and burglaries, snatchings, motorcycles and vehicle thefts and miscellaneous types of thefts.

After enrolment, the *Praharis* are trained by the Delhi Police to help and coordinate in overseeing the safety and security of public and property in the residential and market areas.

The objectives of the Scheme are broadly as follows:

- a) To identify crime-prone areas.
- b) To reduce property crime.
- c) To foster police-public relations.
- d) To increase community participation in prevention and detection of crime.

3. ROLE OF PRAHARIS

In many cases, chowkidars, guards and village watchmen have played a vital role not only in preventing crimes like theft, burglary, robbery etc. but also in providing vital clues in heinous cases as also about criminal/anti-social elements visiting the area. To establish a mutual relationship with the *Praharis* on the basis of a common objective of promoting security and safety of people is in the interests of Delhi Police.

Specifically, the *Praharis* will be required to discharge the following functions:

- a) Make the residents aware about the identity/photographs, addresses and modus operandi of the criminals/burglars residing in their area, so that any suspicious movement of such bad elements could be reported promptly to the police.
- b) Help the local police in verifying antecedents of regular visitors like plumbers, electricians, masons, carpenters, telephone technicians, vendors, hawkers, sweepers, vegetable sellers and other persons regularly doing odd jobs in the locality.

- c) Help the police in collecting the particulars of all domestic servants, chowkidars, drivers and also their relatives residing or working in the locality to verify their antecedents.
- d) Assist the police in keeping watch on BCs/drug-addicts/rowdies residing in the locality and record their details with the local police, so that they do not indulge in any crime.
- e) Collect and provide timely information to the local police that may have a bearing on crime prevention, on community spirit and on police-community relations.

4. **ROLE OF POLICE**

- i) The success of the *Prahar* Scheme will depend critically on the constant encouragement and supervision by the police. The local SHO and the ACP will have to take personal interest in ensuring that the *Praharis* exert themselves and perform their role with due motivation.
- ii) The Scheme will work under the close supervision of the district DCP. The police will have to frequently interact with all partners of the Scheme and brief them again and again on crime prevention measures, and on active participation by the residents in the overall implementation of the Scheme.
- iii) The SHO shall regularly hold meetings with the *Praharis* and also attend monthly meetings of ACP/DCP with the members to examine how they can help in improving the law & order situation in the area.
- iv) The SHO shall play a crucial role in training the *Praharis* in matters like how to observe and report a crime, on how to note down the descriptive role of a criminal or a vehicle and how to preserve a scene of crime etc.
- v) The Beat Officer will be another police functionary who will be closely involved in this Scheme, and work closely with all the coordinators/ partners of this scheme.
- vi) The Beat Officer will be the critical field-level functionary to maintain regular contact with the *Praharis*, and constantly guide and sensitize them.

5. ROLE OF RWAs & MWAs

It is a common community policing requirement that the public must be involved with the local police in a big way for effective watch in the area and for quick flow of information related to crime prevention and detection. The *Prahari* Scheme cannot be successful without the help and cooperation of the residents of the area. For effective implementation to serve the purpose of introducing *Prahari* Scheme, it is essential that the RWAs/MWAs should be actively associated with the Scheme. While understanding the need for effective security in the present scenario, RWAs/MWAs and residents should allow and motivate their Chowkidars, Guards, Watchman to volunteer for enrolment as *Prahari*. RWAs/MWAs also have a critical role in ensuring that the *Praharis* are well equipped with all necessary security equipment.

Since the *Prahari* Scheme cannot be successful without the help and cooperation of the residents of the area, the residents will have to inculcate the qualities of alertness and close community spirit and be prepared to work in cooperation with the police for the prevention of crime. Broadly, each resident can perform the following functions as a support member of the programme:-

- a) Keep a look out for strangers and suspicious persons visiting the locality.
- b) If a neighbour is away on work or on vacation and his house is empty, it will be the duty of the residents living nearby to keep a watch on his house and promptly inform the local coordinator/police if they see any strangers or suspicious movements around his house. Thus, each neighbour will act as a watchman of his own as well as his neighbours' property.
- c) Keep a watch for abandoned vehicles and parking of suspicious vehicles in the locality.
- d) Keep a watch for strangers who knock on doors or peep through window or try to open car/doors.
- e) Remain vigilant in local public parks and play-grounds for eve-teasers, thieves and suspicious looking persons.
- f) Show vigilance and concern in respect of elderly persons, widows and other women, who stay alone and also housewives and children who are alone during day time in the neighbourhood.
- g) When possible, participate in patrolling with local police, *Praharis*, Police *Mitras* and Delhi Home Guards.

Joint patrolling by the residents along with policemen and *Praharis* can also be useful for crime prevention in a locality.

6. ENROLMENT AS PRAHARI

All Chowkidars and Guards of all the Districts are eligible for enrolment as *Praharis*. It should, however, be ensured that these private security guards and chowkidars are not involved in any criminal case, and are residents of /or working in the same police station where they want to get enlisted.

- (i) For enrolment or enlistment as a *Prahari*, a volunteer i.e. interested Security Guard or Chowkidar has to fill-in a '**Prahari Enrolment Form**' in triplicate as per **Annexure-A**.
- (ii) The original copy shall be kept in the Personal File of the *Prahari* at the Police Station.
- (iii) The duplicate copy along with a forwarding letter of the SHO shall be sent to the concerned police station(s) of the permanent address of the applicant/*Prahari* for verification of character and antecedents.
- (iv) After receipt of the verification report, the Beat Officer concerned shall fill-in a 'Local Enquiry Report' as per **Annexure-B**.
- (v) Thereafter, the SHO will forward the third copy of Enrolment Form along with his recommendations for enlistment of the applicant as a *Prahari* to the General Branch of the District i.e. HAG through the ACP/SDPO.
- (vi) The HAG will put up the recommendations before the District DCP for enlistment and issue of ID card.

7. IDENTITY CARDS

All enlisted *Praharis* will be issued a specially designed 'Prahari Identity Card' as per **Annexure-C** by the concerned Deputy Commissioner of Police. This Identity Card will be renewed every year subject to fulfillment of the eligibility criteria.

[It may be noted that the issue of an Identity Card by District DCP per se will not entitle the card holder to be a police officer or a public servant in any manner whatsoever. It also will not entitle him to claim any wage or honorarium (except Cash Rewards granted in exceptional cases) nor will it confer any right or claim a police officer or a public servant entitled to. The *Prahari* Scheme is purely a voluntary service and issue of an Identity Card is just an accreditation of such a voluntary service.]

8. PRAHARI KIT

Every *Prahari* will be given a kit on his enlistment by liaison with the concerned RWA/MWA. This kit should consist of a fluorescent jacket, whistle, torch, cap, shoes and lathi. This kit should be given once every 3 years.

9. TRAINING

All *Praharis* will be given 'Basic Orientation on Security Trends' (BOOST) on enlistment in the *Prahari* Scheme. There will also be regular modules on latest security gadgets, crime prevention strategies, 'Eyes and Ears' Scheme, etc. *Praharis* will be given training in various aspects of area surveillance, checking, frisking, keeping watch on doubtful elements etc. A syllabus/course material should be prepared for the purpose by the district DCP for organizing the training for *Praharis*.

10. MEETINGS

Every month, a meeting will be held at the Sub-division level which will chaired by the concerned SDPO and attended by all SHOs, Inspectors, Division Officers and Beat staff of that Sub-division. The Minutes shall be drawn and the compliance will be put up before the District DCP within a week's time. A separate seat will be formed in the General Branch of the District to deal with the matters and correspondences related to this Scheme.

11. REWARDS

Instances of good work done by a *Prahari* will be duly recognized in the form of a suitable cash reward with Commendation Card by the District DCP. This should preferably be given in a special programme at the District level by inviting all the stakeholders so as to further boost their motivation.

12. REGISTERS AND RECORDS

A register for maintaining the details of all the *Praharis* shall be kept in the concerned police station as per Annexure-D. Besides this register, a Personal File shall also be maintained for each individual *Prahari* for keeping the original copy of the 'Prahari Enrolment Form' along with other miscellaneous papers received from time to time like character verification report, photocopy of Identity Card issued, copy of rewards issued, appreciation letters from RWA/MWA or residents etc.

Similarly, a police station-wise register shall also be maintained by the General Branch (HAG) of the District as per Annexure-E in respect of all the *Praharis* of the District. The recommendations received from the police stations

for enlistment of *Praharis* shall also be placed in a Folder for each police station separately.

13. PRAHARI DATABASE

Crime Branch, PHQ will develop a suitable software and prepare a Digitalized Database of all the *Praharis* in Delhi which can be accessed at the District and Police Station levels as well. This Database shall be maintained in the Crime Branch CRO and updated from time to time.

14. CONCLUSION

For the success of the Scheme, the police will have to ensure that the interest of *Praharis* is sustained on a long-term basis for which purpose, strict implementation of the instructions contained in this Standing Order shall be ensured by all concerned.


(Amulya Patnaik),
Commissioner of Police,
Delhi.

OB No. 06 /RB/PHQ dated 26-03-18

No. 755-805 /Record Branch/PHQ dated Delhi, the 26-03-18

Copy to:-

1. All Special Commissioners of Police, Delhi.
2. All Joint/Addl. Commissioners of Police, Delhi.
3. Dy. Commissioners of Police, Districts/Units including FRRO, Railways, Metro, IGIA & Spl. Cell, SPUWAC, IT Centre, Delhi/New Delhi.
4. SO to CP and LA to CP, Delhi.
5. All ACsP/SDPOs and SHOs in Delhi.
6. Record Branch, PHQ and Library, PHQ, Delhi with 5 spare copies each.
8. IT Centre/PHQ, Delhi.
9. Guard file.

DELHI POLICE PRAHARI SCHEME



PRAHARI ENROLMENT FORM

SL. No. _____ POLICE STATION _____ DISTRICT _____

DETAILS OF PRAHARI

1. Name (with alias, if any) _____

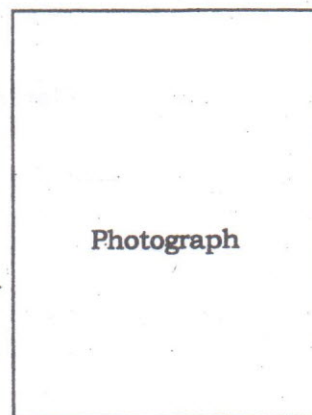
2. Father's Name _____

3. Mother's Name _____

4. Place & Date of Birth _____

5. Education: _____

6. Language spoken _____



7. Address:

(1) Present:

_____ Tel. _____

(2) Permanent:

8. Details of identification proof like Ration Card/Driving Licence/Photo ID Card, if any

DELHI POLICE PRAHARI SCHEME



PRAHARI ENROLMENT FORM

SL. No. _____ POLICE STATION _____ DISTRICT _____

DETAILS OF PRAHARI

1. Name (with alias, if any) _____

2. Father's Name _____

3. Mother's Name _____

4. Place & Date of Birth _____

5. Education: _____

6. Language spoken _____

Photograph

7. Address:

(1) Present:

_____ Tel. _____

(2) Permanent:

8. Details of identification proof like Ration Card/Driving Licence/Photo ID Card, if any

DELHI POLICE PRAHARI SCHEME



LOCAL ENQUIRY REPORT

Name of Beat Officer with rank: _____

Belt No. _____ PIS No. _____ Mobile No. _____

Police Station _____ District _____

1. Result of verification from CRO: _____

2. Result of verification from previous employers (to be done by the Beat Officer):

Result of verification from the concerned Police Station of previous employer (to be done by Beat Officer) : _____

3. Details of Enrolment Form sent to the SHO of Home Town/Permanent Address:

PS _____ District _____ State _____

Dispatch No. _____ Date _____

4. Result of verification from home town /Date & details of verification received from home town : _____

(Signature of Beat Officer)

(Signature of SHO)

Front Side

PRAHARI SCHEME



IDENTITY CARD No.

PRAHARI No.

Name: _____

Son / Daughter of:

P.S.:

District:

Date of Issue:

Photograph

Sign of Issuing Authority with Stamp

The Card Holder is not a police officer, but he is engaged in voluntary service of Delhi Police Prahari Scheme.

Back Side

Identification Marks:

Date of Birth:

Signature of Holder:

Thumb Impression:

In case found, drop this card in nearest letter box or hand over to the nearest police station. Unauthorized use of this card may attract penal action.

DELHI POLICE PRAHARI SCHEME

PRAHARI REGISTER

1.	Sl. No.		PHOTO
2.	Name, present address and mobile No. of Prahari		
3.	Name, address & telephone no. of employer		
4.	Permanent Address of Prahari		
5.	Details of identity proof himself or family members		
6.	Name and address of previous employer, if any		
7.	Name and number of the Beat Officer who conducted local enquiry		
8.	Gist of Enquiry Findings		
9.	Identity Card No. of the Prahari		
10.	Remarks, if any		

DELHI POLICE PRAHARI SCHEME

POLICE STATION-WISE PRAHARI REGISTER

Police station _____ District _____

Sl. No.	Name, address & telephone number of the Prahari	Name & Address of Employer	ID Card No. issued with date of Issue	Signature of officer Issuing the ID Card